

LOKESH A

Network Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Network Engineer with 2 years of hands-on experience in enterprise network infrastructure, network security, and systems administration. Skilled in FortiGate firewall administration, firewall policy management, NAT, SSL-VPN, IPsec VPN, SD-WAN, SD-WAN rules, VLANs, D-Link switching, LAN/WAN troubleshooting, and Windows/Linux administration. Experienced in network monitoring, incident troubleshooting, SLA-based technical support, and maintaining high network availability and experienced in managing Active Directory environments.

EDUCATION

B.A. in Defence and Strategic Studies Graduated 2022

Voorhees College, Vellore, Tamil Nadu

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Fortinet Certified Associate in Cybersecurity (FCA) | Validation:** 3684511744LA | Oct 30, 2024 – Oct 30, 2026
- **Fortinet Certified Fundamentals in Cybersecurity (FCF) | Validation:** 8542176905LA | Dec 5, 2024 – Dec 5, 2026
- **Free CCNA 200-301 (Network Chuck) | Certificate:** u7399670 | Coursera

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Network Security & Firewall: FortiGate Firewall | Firewall Policy Management | Security Policies | NAT | SSL-VPN | IPsec VPN | SD-WAN | SD-WAN Rules | Firewall Troubleshooting | Traffic Monitoring

Systems Administration: Windows Server | Active Directory (AD) | Group Policy Objects (GPO) | DNS | DHCP | Linux Administration (Ubuntu)

Cloud & Emerging Skills: AWS (Learning) | Cloud Networking Fundamentals

WORK EXPERIENCE

Network Engineer | Sardonyx Technologies

Sep 2024 – Present

- Managed and monitored enterprise network infrastructure — routers, switches, and firewalls — across multiple sites, maintaining 99%+ uptime.
- Administered and optimized FortiGate firewalls, including firewall policies, security rules, ACLs, NAT, and traffic-control configurations to enhance network security and performance.
- Configured and managed FortiGate SSL-VPN and IPsec VPN tunnels for secure remote and site-to-site connectivity, troubleshooting connectivity and tunnel issues.
- Deployed and maintained FortiGate SD-WAN, including WAN member configuration, performance-based path selection, and traffic-steering rules for optimized WAN utilization and application performance.
- Performed firewall policy reviews, NAT/port-forwarding configuration, and log/traffic analysis to troubleshoot, optimize, and resolve network security and connectivity incidents.
- Administered D-Link switches including VLAN configuration, trunking for optimal traffic segmentation across office networks.

- Managed Active Directory, user/group provisioning, GPO configuration, and DNS/DHCP administration.
- Administered Linux servers (Ubuntu) for configuration management, log monitoring, and service management.
- Resolved Level 1 and Level 2 network and system tickets, consistently meeting SLA targets (95%+ resolution rate).

PROJECTS

FTP Server Deployment for Edge Device Firmware Management (Ubuntu)

- Deployed and configured a secure FTP server using vsftpd on Ubuntu to centralize firmware distribution for ~200 edge devices across the network.
- Implemented SSL/TLS encryption using custom OpenSSL certificates, ensuring secure and authenticated firmware transfers.
- Streamlined the firmware upgrade process for edge devices, reducing manual effort and minimizing update-related downtime.

On-Premises Local LLM Deployment

- Deployed an offline AI solution using Ollama and Open WebUI to provide internal users with a private, API-independent AI interface.
- Successfully enabled up to 10 concurrent users with available hardware; identified GPU resource constraints as the primary bottleneck for further scaling.
- Eliminated dependency on external AI APIs, ensuring full data privacy and compliance for internal use cases.

Windows Server & High Availability Cluster

- Configured a multi-user Active Directory environment managing 300+ employee accounts, groups, and group policies (GPO) to enforce security and desktop standards.
- Implemented Windows Failover Clustering for high availability and fault tolerance across critical server workloads.
- Diagnosed and resolved cluster service failures and node communication issues to maintain business continuity.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced network downtime by proactively identifying and resolving recurring FortiGate firewall policy misconfigurations.
- Led VLAN restructuring across office networks, improving traffic segmentation and overall security posture.
- Maintained 95%+ SLA ticket resolution rate in a high-volume enterprise IT environment.
- Deployed FTP infrastructure that automated firmware updates for ~200 edge devices, replacing a previously manual process.